

ESSENTIAL

Financial Requirements Overview

The cost-of-living formula and acceptable evidence

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

This route has a published, formula-based requirement

Unlike the Visitor Visa (which has no fixed minimum - see that visa type's own documents if you're applying for both), the Study Permit's financial requirement is a specific, published formula covering three components: your tuition, a fixed cost-of-living figure, and return transportation.

The formula

- Tuition payable: your first year's tuition fees, as stated on your Letter of Acceptance (minus any amount already paid, if your evidence shows it)
- Cost of living: a published amount for a single applicant, based on Canada's Low Income Cut-Off (LICO) figures - this amount is updated periodically by IRCC and is not reproduced as a fixed figure here; check the current published amount on IRCC's website
- Return transportation: a reasonable estimate of the cost to return home
- If family members are accompanying you, an additional published amount is added per accompanying family member

Total required = tuition payable + cost of living (base, plus any per-family-member additions) + return transportation. See the Financial Planning Calculator (Premium tier) for a live version of this formula you can fill in with your own numbers and the current published amounts.

How this differs from the 28-day rule elsewhere

Canada doesn't publish a fixed consecutive-holding-period rule the way some other countries' student routes do. What matters is that your evidence is recent and credible - a Guaranteed Investment Certificate (GIC) from a participating Canadian institution, recent bank statements showing an ongoing pattern rather than a single snapshot, a loan approval letter, or a paid tuition/housing receipt are all commonly accepted forms.

Acceptable evidence

- A GIC from a participating Canadian financial institution, specifically for the living-cost portion
- Personal or parental bank statements showing an ongoing pattern of funds, not a single recent large deposit
- An official student/education loan approval letter
- Proof of paid tuition and/or on-campus housing, which can offset part of the required amount
- A scholarship or government sponsorship letter, for the portion it covers

Red flags

- A large, recent, unexplained deposit shortly before applying
- Evidence that doesn't clearly match the tuition amount on your Letter of Acceptance
- A sponsorship letter that doesn't clearly state the amount and duration of the commitment